

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1992-06-24

1 dear bahá'í friends,

2 As you are already aware from previous communications, the bahá'í holy
3 places and other properties and endowments belonging to the bahá'í com-
4 munity of iran are still under government control. many have been desecrat-
5 ed or demolished and the sites used for constructing roads or other buildings.
6 Among these confiscated properties was the once beautiful and well-kept
7 bahá'í cemetery in Tehran. it has been desecrated and the headstones and
8 marble coverings of the graves were removed and later sold in auctions. All
identification marks on the graves were obliterated, and a school and
9 playground are being built on this site.

The bahá'í community had owned a large piece of property to the south

10 of Tehran which was intended for use as the future cemetery of the Tehran 132.1

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134 m e S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e

135 282 bahá'í community. This was also confiscated and all petitions to regain it
136 have been fruitless. instead, a small, barren piece of land without any public
137 service or utilities was assigned to the bahá'ís of Tehran by the iranian gov-
138 ernment for use as a burial site for their dead. however, neither headstones
139 nor any identification of the individual graves are permitted on that site.

140 A bahá'í friend living in the united States, who visited iran in october

141 1991, has described it as very depressing. The bodies of the dead have to be prepared
for burial at home or water has to be fetched for that purpose from a christian cemetery in
the neighborhood. . . .

142 it should be recalled that most of the bahá'í cemeteries in iran have been

143 desecrated or demolished and that thousands of bahá'ís who wish to visit

144 these cemeteries in order to pray for their departed relatives are either denied access,
or they return with grieved hearts after witnessing the deplorable

145 condition of the graves of their loved ones. moreover, many of the bahá'í

146 martyrs executed in prison have been buried in areas not even known to

147 their relatives.

148 with loving bahá'í greetings,

Department of the Secretariat

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Murder of a Bahá'í in Iran

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]